



STAKEHOLDER BRIEFING · REVISED JUNE 2026

# PolyWiz Paid Ads Engine

A new campaign *class* beside the organic engine —  
conversion-oriented ads, multi-objective, configured per  
brand

Pilot: open-call submissions

Multi-objective

Per-brand config

## WHERE THIS COMES FROM

# This year's exhibition initiative — and the one gap in it

It keeps coming up in our weekly staff calls: we put **hundreds of hours** into curating open calls and exhibitions — but we don't really *promote* them. The work is strong; it just doesn't reach far enough.

### THE FOCUS THIS YEAR

Get our exhibitions **seen** — especially the **partner shows** — and **lift open-call submission rates**.

Promotion is what makes the curation pay off.

### TWO IDEAS BEHIND IT

**011** — an owned promotion & PR engine.

**007** — a paid-ads engine that drives submissions and exhibition reach.

Developed together, meant to ship together.

## WHERE THIS GOES

# One engine, the whole content universe

We're building an **engine**, not a one-off campaign.

**START HERE** This year's **exhibitions & open calls** — the team's hard work, arguably the best content we have right now, finally getting the promotion it deserves.

**THEN** The same engine reaches everything **Arterial makes** — the Not Real Art and Artsville podcasts, Q+Art (Morgan's interview series), "Remote" (the public-art video series), and more across our brands.

**IN THE FALL** On the road to **fundraising** — once it's proven across the content universe, the same engine powers the fall fundraising push too.

We don't launch all of this at once. We build the engine once, then point it — one focused step at a time. First: this year's exhibitions.

## THE CORE IDEA

# Ads are a different animal — a new campaign *class*

PolyWiz today is an **organic trickling engine** — a URL becomes a six-month tapering series of posts. A paid ad campaign is a fundamentally different object. We add it **beside** the organic engine, not inside it.

### ORGANIC CAMPAIGN · EXISTS TODAY

**Unit** — 6-month series of dozens of posts

**Lifecycle** — tapering schedule → publish → done

**Goal** — reach, cadence, presence

**Optimizer** — our distribution-bias schedule

**Metric** — posts shipped, reach

### PAID AD CAMPAIGN · THIS IDEA

**Unit** — 1–few ads × many **variations**, tested at once

**Lifecycle** — budgeted flight → learning → kill / scale

**Goal** — **conversion** — submit, register, subscribe, donate

**Optimizer** — the ad platform's algorithm

**Metric** — **cost per action**

Forcing this into "just another organic campaign type" would bury a budget-driven, conversion-optimized object inside a generator built for cadence. **Two sibling classes instead.**

## WHAT'S SHARED, WHAT DIVERGES

# One intake. Two engines.

Both classes start **identically** — paste a URL, scrape it, pull brand voice and visuals. That overlap is real and worth reusing. After intake they diverge completely.

### SHARED INTAKE SUBSTRATE · ALREADY BUILT

URL → Firecrawl scrape → brand voice → image catalog → auto-crop → creative gen

#### ↓ ORGANIC DIVERGES TO

A tapering post-series on a cadence schedule.

#### ↓ PAID DIVERGES TO

Ads × variations on a budgeted flight — with an **objective, investment level, platform mix, flight length, ad account, audience, and landing page** — and an optimization loop that kills losers and scales winners.

## LAYER 2 — THE OBJECTIVES

# One engine, many conversion objectives

Within a paid campaign, the **objective** is the conversion dimension. Each sets the platform goal, the conversion event, the creative angles, the platform mix, the pacing, and the KPI.

|                                      |                     |                                      |                                                       |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Open-call submissions</b> · pilot | Submit / Lead       | deadline · prize · eligibility       | Meta + Pinterest + Google Ad Grants · deadline flight |
| <b>Exhibition interest</b>           | View →<br>Subscribe | visual hero · artist spotlight       | Pinterest + IG + Meta · run-of-show                   |
| <b>Newsletter growth</b>             | Subscribe           | value-of-issue · FOMO                | Meta + newsletter ad networks · always-on             |
| <b>Event / workshop</b> · occasional | RSVP / Register     | date · lineup · local                | Meta + Nextdoor (local) · date flight                 |
| <b>Fundraising / donations</b>       | Donate /<br>Pledge  | impact · matching-gift · partnership | Meta + Google Ad Grants + email · seasonal            |

Fundraising is in the vision from day one — built last. It's the highest-interest objective and a 501(c)(3) governance asset (the "broad support from 500+ donors" public-support test). But donation conversion is the hardest to build, so we prove the engine on the easy, measurable objectives first.



LAYER 3 — PER-BRAND CONFIGURATION

Which objectives a brand can run is a brand setting

Not every objective applies to every brand — fundraising is irrelevant to a for-profit; The Intersect may only ever grow its list. Same gating PolyWiz already uses for per-brand feature flags, extended to **enabled objectives + connected ad accounts + budget envelope** per brand.

|               | OPEN CALLS | EXHIBITIONS | NEWSLETTER | EVENTS     | FUNDRAISING |
|---------------|------------|-------------|------------|------------|-------------|
| Not Real Art  | ✓          | ✓           | ✓          | occasional | ✓ last      |
| Artsville USA | ✓          | ✓           | ✓          | ✓          | ✓ last      |
| The Intersect | —          | —           | ✓          | —          | —           |

Every brand sees only the objectives it's configured for. **One engine, per-brand capability surface** — illustrative; final values are a config decision.

## A DESIGN QUESTION WORTH CALLING OUT

Exhibition interest is a *dual* objective — a newsletter feeder

### THE PROBLEM

A bare "they viewed the exhibition" is a weak success signal. Looking isn't interest. Optimizing only for views buys traffic we can't follow up with.



### THE DESIGN

Optimize for the *view* as the platform conversion *and* layer a *secondary capture* on the landing page — prompt the engaged visitor to *subscribe, follow the exhibition, or follow the brand* via scroll-depth / time-on-page / exit-intent CTAs.

*The compounding loop.* A paid exhibition flight produces views now, captured subscribers/followers from the interested minority, and a retargeting pool that makes the *next* campaign cheaper. The same secondary-capture pattern applies to open calls (non-submitters → newsletter) and, later, fundraising (interested non-donors → cultivation list). Idea 011 names this loop.



## WHAT WE ALREADY HAVE VS. WHAT'S NEW

# The build is mostly extension, not invention

### SHARED SUBSTRATE · ALREADY BUILT

- ✓ Start-from-URL → Firecrawl scrape
- ✓ Brand voice + tone
- ✓ Multi-platform copy generation (Claude)
- ✓ Image catalog from scraped URLs
- ✓ Auto-crop to platform aspect ratios
- ✓ Vercel Blob image hosting
- ✓ Per-brand keys + feature flags
- ✓ Zernio integration (organic + now ads)

### NEW FOR THE PAID CLASS

- + Paid campaign object (objective, budget, flight)
- + Ad-variation generator (FLUX, Ideogram)
- + Zernio Ads via SDK (0.2.101 — no raw fetch)
- + Per-brand ad-account wiring (OAuth)
- + Event-driven lead capture (webhooks, not polling)
- + Conversion-objective config per brand
- + Variant rotation (kill / scale loop)
- + Secondary-capture CTAs on landing pages

The creative engine is the moat. The new pieces are the ad object, its config, and the optimization loop.

## NO NEW VENDOR, NO NEW LOGINS

It runs through the same tool the brands already use

Paid ads go out through **Zernio** — the exact same service the brands already use to schedule their organic social posts. There's nothing new to learn, no extra account to sign into, and no second vendor to manage. Turning the ads capability on is a single flat **\$100/mo** add-on to that existing subscription — one shared cost across every brand and objective.

### ONE TOOL · SIX PAID NETWORKS

**Meta** — Facebook + Instagram

**Pinterest**

**Google**

**LinkedIn**

**TikTok**

**X**

### SAME TOOL

Already in use for organic posting. Paid ads are turned on inside it — no migration, no new system.

### EACH BRAND STAYS SEPARATE

Every brand connects its own ad account, so budgets and reporting never cross between brands.

## PHASE PLAN

Build order  $\neq$  vision order — fundraising last

- **Phase 0 — Prerequisites** ~1 day  
Confirm the Zernio plan covers ads (likely bundled). Connect per-brand ad accounts via OAuth. Install Pixel + Conversions API on the brand sites that lack them.
- **Phase 1 — Paid class + open-call pilot** ~1–2 weeks  
Build the paid campaign object, config surface, variation generator, ad-account wiring, `lead.received` capture. Run the open-call submission pilot at ~\$250 on the next live call.
- **Phase 2 — Objective + platform expansion** ~1.5 weeks  
Add exhibition interest (+ secondary capture) and newsletter growth; turn on Pinterest (visual) and newsletter ad networks. Per-brand objective config UI.
- **Phase 3 — Video + fundraising** ~1.5 weeks  
Slideshow-video creative for TikTok/YouTube. **Fundraising / donation objective** with value-based optimization + donor compliance. Google Ad Grants for nonprofit search.
- **Phase 4 — Optimization & scale** ongoing  
Per-variant landing pages. Engaged-subscriber lookalikes. Cross-brand reporting. Auto-pacing on cost-per-action.

## WHAT PHASE 0 CLEARS

# Three prerequisites — days, not weeks

1

### **\$100/mo ads add-on**

A flat monthly subscription on the existing Zernio account. **One shared cost** across every brand and objective — not per brand, and separate from per-flight ad spend.

2

### **Connect per-brand ad accounts**

Each brand's Meta / Pinterest ad account via Zernio OAuth (`/v1/connect/{platform}/ads`). Budget authority decided per brand.

3

### **Pixel + Conversions API**

Server-side CAPL lifts conversion capture from 70–80% to 90–95%. Artsville needs the Pixel; Intersect-on-Curated needs CAPL.

All three are **solvable in days** — but they precede the first ad flight.

## WHAT WE'RE ASKING FOR

# A green light for Phase 0 + the open-call pilot

### MONTHLY COMMITMENT

**\$100/mo**

The flat Zernio ads add-on Scott absorbs monthly — one shared engine across brands & objectives, plus per-flight ad spend.

### RUN ONE FLIGHT

**~\$250 open call**

A deadline-timed flight on the next live open call — Not Real Art or Artsville.

### SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

**Cost /  
submission**

Our **first-ever clean reading** — we've never measured it. That number unlocks every other brand and objective.

**What's already covered:** the build is baked into the existing Polymash retainer — **no new line item**. The only new money is the incremental platform + ad spend above.

This **~\$250 pilot is step one** toward promoting the whole content universe, on the road to fundraising. The decision in front of us: **a green light to run that first focused step**.



# Let's run the first open call

007 + 011 ship together. The build lives in the GitHub epic — [issue #181](#)



## SOURCES & REFERENCES

# Sources & References

All research lives in [ideas/007-polywiz-paid-ads-engine/research/](#) — phase sub-issues, plus [sources.md](#) with every URL, quote, retrieval date, and defensibility note.

Zernio Ads add-on = \$100/mo on our AppSumo account — Zernio in-product paywall, confirmed 2026-06-18 (not bundled for legacy/AppSumo plans; flat monthly fee, separate from ad spend)

Andromeda rewards creative volume + diversity — [Meta Engineering, Dec 2024](#)

Pinterest CPC 30–50% cheaper than Meta; 619M MAU — [WebFX 2026](#) · [Pinterest Q4 2025](#)

Google Ad Grants — \$10k/mo free for 501(c)(3)s — [Google for Nonprofits](#) · captured in idea 011's master resource

Zernio Ads API re-verified — 6 networks, ad webhooks, SDK 0.2.101 ads namespaces — [Zernio OpenAPI v1.0.4, retrieved 2026-06-18](#)

17.8% lower cost-per-result with CAPI — [Meta announcement, Apr 2026](#)

Detailed interest targeting deprecated Jan 2026 — [Meta Help Center via Brandwatch](#)

Plus first-party data (\$0.80–\$0.90 historical CPA on \$70K/yr Meta budgets; brand pixel status; 011's open-call landing-page campaign evidence) — logged in [research/sources.md](#)